

◆ MYSTIC ACADEMY ◆

The Lost Relic

Product Requirements Document

Version 2.1 · MVP Scope · Web Prototype

Project	Mystic Academy: The Lost Relic
Type	Browser-Based Fantasy Adventure Game
Phase	MVP — Playable Web Prototype
Target	Desktop & Mobile Browsers
Playtime	15 – 25 minutes
Audience	Freelance Developers / AI Coding Agents

1. Project Overview

Mystic Academy: The Lost Relic is a short, browser-based fantasy adventure game. Players arrive as a new student at a small magical academy on the same day an ancient artifact — the Celestial Relic — mysteriously disappears. Over 15–25 minutes they navigate 3–4 connected academy locations, speak with characters, use one spell mechanic, solve 2–3 puzzles, and reach a short ending scene that resolves the mystery.

The goal is a polished proof-of-concept that showcases the atmosphere, exploration, storytelling, and magical theme — not a full RPG. Focus is on user experience, visual presentation, and core gameplay mechanics.

2. Scope of Work

In Scope

- Landing page with game title and Start Game button
- Character creation — name input and avatar selection (3–4 avatar options)
- 3–4 connected academy locations with point-and-click or keyboard navigation

- Dialogue system with speaker name, portrait, and manual text advance
- 2–3 quests with real-time quest tracker
- 2–3 puzzles — rune matching, object interaction, or clue finding
- One spell mechanic — learned mid-game, used once to unlock an object or advance the story
- Story arc: introduction → investigation → short ending scene with genuine resolution
- Auto-save via browser localStorage; Continue option on return visit
- Responsive UI for desktop and mobile browsers
- Placeholder fantasy assets (icons, backgrounds, sound effects) from free/licensed sources
- Source code, setup documentation, and a tested production web build

Out of Scope

Multiplayer · combat system · enemy AI · inventory management · achievements · XP / leveling · skill trees · advanced spell systems · custom artwork · voice acting · backend / auth · cloud saves · leaderboards · monetization · app store deployment · large open-world exploration.

3. Academy Locations

Implement 3–4 locations from the table below. Each must connect logically to the next. Every location must contain at least one interactive object, one story detail, and one clue.

Location	Story Role
Academy Entrance / Courtyard	Arrival point · first NPC · mystery introduced
Library	Clues in readable objects · one puzzle · librarian NPC
Spell Classroom	Spell mechanic introduced · professor NPC
Corridor / Hidden Passage	Transitional space · spell used to unlock path
Inner Chamber / Vault	Final location · ending scene plays here

4. Game Systems

Navigation

Animated fade transition between locations (500–700 ms). Current location always labeled on screen. All visited locations remain accessible.

Dialogue

Speaker name and portrait shown. Player advances text manually. No walls of text. Max 2 dialogue choices where branching is needed.

Quests

2–3 quests (1 main, 1–2 side). Each has a name, short description, and 1–3 objectives. Quest tracker visible at all times. Completion triggers an on-screen notification.

Puzzles

2–3 puzzles. Solutions fixed between sessions (no randomization). All clues exist within the game. Failed attempts show feedback; player is never locked out.

Spell

Exactly one spell. Learned through a story event. Triggers a particle/glow visual effect plus cast and resolution audio. Used at one specific story-critical moment.

Save / Load

Auto-save after: quest objective complete, puzzle solved, location visited, ending reached. On reload: offer Continue or New Game. Handle missing or corrupt data gracefully.

5. Design Rules

- 1. Every location must contain at least one interactive object, one story detail, and one clue.
- 2. UI must feel like part of the magical world — no generic flat-design components.
- 3. The spell cast must have a visual effect and audio cue — it must feel magical.
- 4. Every click must produce visible feedback — no silent interactions.
- 5. Navigation must always be clear — players should never feel lost in a 3–4 room game.
- 6. All dialogue must be purposeful — no filler text, no lorem ipsum anywhere in the build.

6. Visual Direction

Color Palette

Base	Deep indigo #1a1040 · Midnight blue #0d0d2b · Dark charcoal #1c1c2e
Accent	Gold #c9a84c · Aged brass #b87333 · Warm amber #ff9a3c
Magic	Arcane violet #7b2fff · Electric cyan #00e5ff · Soft white #f0f0ff
Earth	Forest green #2d6a4f · Stone grey #8d8d8d · Parchment #f5e6c8
Alert	Deep crimson #8b0000

Typography

Display / Headings	Cinzel or similar medieval serif
Body / UI copy	Clean readable serif or humanist sans-serif · 16px desktop min · 14px mobile min
Runic / Accent	In-world magical inscriptions and puzzle rune labels only — never for UI copy

General Rules

- Illustrated or painted backgrounds — no stock photography
- Consistent portrait style across all NPCs and player avatars
- No mixing of flat-design UI elements with illustrated fantasy elements
- All third-party assets documented with source and license

7. Technical Stack

Framework	React 18+
Build	Next.js 14+ App Router (or Vite + React if simpler for this scope)
Language	TypeScript — strict mode enabled
Styling	Tailwind CSS
Animation	Framer Motion
State	Zustand
Storage	localStorage via custom hook with error handling

Folder Structure

```
/src/app # Routes and pages
/src/components/ui # Reusable primitives
/src/components/game # Scene, navigation, dialogue
/src/components/puzzles # Puzzle overlays
/src/components/hud # Quest tracker, spell button, location label
/src/systems # Quest, dialogue, puzzle, spell, save logic
/src/data # JSON files – quests, dialogue, locations, puzzles
/src/stores # Zustand stores
/src/types # TypeScript interfaces
/src/hooks # Custom hooks
/public/assets # Audio, images, fonts
```

Data-driven content is required. All dialogue, quest definitions, location data, and puzzle configs must live in /data JSON files — never hardcoded inside components.

8. Performance Targets

Lighthouse Performance	85+
Lighthouse Accessibility	90+
First Contentful Paint	< 1.5 s

Largest Contentful Paint	< 2.5 s
Time to Interactive	< 3.0 s
Cumulative Layout Shift	< 0.1

Test on mobile (mid-range Android, 4G simulation in Lighthouse) — desktop-only results are not acceptable.

9. Code Standards

- ESLint + Prettier configured — zero warnings on commit
- No console.log in production builds — use a logger utility
- No ts-ignore — resolve all TypeScript strict mode errors
- All exported components and functions have JSDoc comments
- No hardcoded game content inside component files
- README.md must include setup, dev workflow, and env variable documentation
- All async operations must have error handling — no unhandled promise rejections

10. Deliverables

Source Code	Git repo with clean commit history · zero lint and type errors
README.md	Setup instructions, local dev workflow, env variables
DATA_SCHEMA.md	JSON data file schemas with field descriptions and examples
LICENSES.md	All third-party asset and library attributions
DEPLOYMENT.md	Step-by-step deploy instructions for Vercel or Netlify
Production Build	Tested build that runs in a browser without a local server

11. Things to Avoid

- Adding features not listed in Section 2 — flag scope creep before acting on it
- Hardcoded dialogue, quest names, or puzzle data inside component code
- Silent interactions — every click must produce a visible response
- Shrinking the desktop layout for mobile instead of redesigning it
- Generic RPG asset packs that visually mismatch the dark academia direction
- Mixing icon packs or illustration styles from different sources
- An ending scene that says 'To be continued' or stops without resolution
- Unhandled localStorage failures — always catch errors and fall back gracefully

12. Definition of Done

The MVP is accepted when all of the following are true:

- Complete flow works end-to-end: landing → character creation → exploration → quests → puzzles → spell → ending
- Save and restore works correctly across a full browser reload
- No placeholder text (lorem ipsum, TODO, INSERT DIALOGUE HERE) anywhere in the shipped build
- Runs without console errors in Chrome, Firefox, Safari (macOS + iOS), and Edge
- Fully playable on mobile without horizontal scroll
- Lighthouse Performance 85+, Accessibility 90+
- A new player can finish the full experience in 15–25 minutes without external guidance
- The ending scene provides genuine resolution to the Celestial Relic mystery